

Satellite TV

The two-month cricket extravaganza that is the IPL couldn't have been a success, if not for the nifty satellite television. Delivered through communications satellite and received by an outdoor antenna (read: satellite dish or set-top box), satellite TV enables us idiot box addicts to access a wide range of channels that are often not serviced by cable providers.



This is because even though conceptually satellite television is a lot like broadcast television, what makes it unique is its range and clear signal. Since satellites orbit the planet, there are many more customers in the line of signal. They're all also in geosynchronous orbit, meaning that the satellite stays in one place in the sky relative to the earth so that the signal doesn't need adjusting once the satellite has been launched.

While it may continue to remain one of the least understood technologies for television reception globally it hasn't stopped droves from signing up as new satellite customers primarily because the broadcast is completely digital which means much better picture and sound quality. The best thing about satellite TV in India is that we now have so many channels that one can spend a good two hours just browsing through them all searching for the best show to watch.